ZIMBABWE SCHOOL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

GRADE SEVEN EXAMINATION, 2017.

ENGLISH 001/2

PAPER 2

OCTOBER 2017 SESSION **Time: 1 hour 30 minutes**

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

1. Read **all** the instructions carefully.
2. Do **not** open this question paper until you are told to do so by the invigilator.
3. Use a **blue** or **black** pen to write your answers.
4. Write your name, Centre Number and Candidate Number on the answer paper.
5. Answer **all** the questions on a separate answer paper. In Section A, choose **either** 1(a) **or** 1(b).
6. Write all sentences in good grammar and punctuate them correctly.
7. You are advised to spend 1 hour on Section A and 30 minutes on Section B.
8. If you use more than one sheet of paper, fasten the sheets together.
9. **If you do not understand** the instructions, **ask** the invigilator to explain them to you **before you start writing**.

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SECTION A: COMPOSITION (20 MARKS)

You are advised to spend **1 hour** on this section.

1. Answer **either** 1(a) **or** 1(b).

Either (a)

Write a story about the day you felt ashamed of yourself. Your story should be between **80** and **120** words in length. Use the following points and any other you may think of to write your story.

- when it happened
- where you were
- what happened
- how you felt
- what you learnt from the experience

Or (b)

Someone in your area needs help. Write a letter to your Councillor on behalf of that person and ask for help. The body of your letter should be between **80** and **120** words in length. Use the following points and any other you may think of in writing your letter.

- name of person
- where the person lives
- the kind of help needed
- why the person needs help
- what the local people have done to help

SECTION B: COMPREHENSION (10 MARKS)

You are advised to spend **30 minutes** on this section.

2. Read the following passage very carefully before you attempt any questions.

Answer all the questions in full sentences. You are advised to write your sentences in good grammar and punctuate them correctly.

Hopes of Harvest Lost

At first, it was the fear that crops would be waterlogged by the continuous fall of rains. However, in most parts of the country, the situation has changed. The fear now is that many areas will not be able to harvest enough as crops have started wilting due to the mid-season drought.

Farmers' hopes were raised at the start of the season when rains started falling at a good rate. As the season progressed, many farmers started raising alarm that the continued fall of rains was damaging the crops. The rains then vanished in February, much to the relief of the farmers.

However, that long break in rainfall later caused worry to farmers in many areas. It became clear that crops would be badly affected by the prolonged dry spell. The dry spell destroyed the farmers' hopes.

One such area where hope has suddenly turned to despair is Zaka District, where crops are already considered a write-off. Even drought-resistant crops such as sorghum and millet are slowly giving in to the mid-season drought which has persisted for many weeks.

Adapted from: *The Sunday Mail, 13 – 19 March 2011.*

Questions

(a) What fear did farmers have at the start of the season? [1]

(b) Why were many areas going to fail to make a good harvest? [1]

(c) What had made the farmers hopeful at the beginning of the season? [1]

(d) When did the rains stop? [1]

(e) How did the farmers **at first** feel when the rains stopped? [1]

(f) Which area was badly affected by the prolonged dry spell? [1]

(g) According to the passage, what type of crop is sorghum? [1]

(h) Which word in the last paragraph shows that the farmers had lost hope? [1]

(i) What does the word 'progressed' mean as used in the second paragraph? [1]

(j) What is the source of the passage? [1]